

# I Adam

*The first man, formed from dust, who lost paradise and became the pattern for "the last Adam."*

Adam is the first human being in the Bible and the father of the human family. God formed him from the dust, breathed life into him, and placed him in a garden with good work to do and one command to keep. With Eve, he broke that command, and the story of sin and death begins. Yet God sought him out, clothed him, and promised that the serpent would one day be crushed. Paul calls Jesus "the last Adam," the one who undoes what the first Adam did.

## At a glance

|               |                                                                  |
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| Name          | Hebrew <i>adam</i> , "man," linked with <i>adamah</i> , "ground" |
| Family        | Wife Eve; sons Cain, Abel, Seth and others (Genesis 5:4)         |
| When          | At the beginning; no calendar date given                         |
| Key places    | The garden "eastward in Eden" (Genesis 2:8)                      |
| Key people    | Eve, the serpent, Cain, Abel, Seth                               |
| Lifespan      | 930 years (Genesis 5:5)                                          |
| Main passages | Genesis 1:26–5:5                                                 |
| New Testament | Luke 3:38; Romans 5:12–21; 1 Corinthians 15                      |

*"And the LORD God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul."*

Genesis 2:7, KJV

# The life of Adam

Genesis gives no calendar dates for Adam. Ages follow the Hebrew text; the Septuagint differs. Ussher (1650) placed creation at 4004 BC. Christians differ on reading Genesis 1–3 as six ordinary days or as real history told in a literary way.

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Day six    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Created in God's image</li></ul> <p>God creates humankind in his image; the LORD God forms the man from dust and breathes life into him. <i>Genesis 1:26–31; 2:7</i></p>                 |
| In Eden    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Given work and a command</li></ul> <p>God puts the man in the garden "to dress it and to keep it," forbidding only the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. <i>Genesis 2:8–17</i></p> |
| In Eden    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Names the animals; Eve is made</li></ul> <p>No fitting helper is found among the beasts. God makes the woman from Adam's rib, and Adam welcomes her. <i>Genesis 2:18–25</i></p>          |
| In Eden    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>The fall</li></ul> <p>The woman eats and gives also "unto her husband with her; and he did eat." They hide from God among the trees. <i>Genesis 3:1–8</i></p>                            |
| In Eden    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Judged, clothed and sent out</li></ul> <p>Adam blames the woman. God curses the ground, makes coats of skins, and sends them out. <i>Genesis 3:9–24</i></p>                              |
| After Eden | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Father of Cain and Abel</li></ul> <p>Cain kills his brother, and sin reaches the next generation. <i>Genesis 4:1–16</i></p>                                                              |
| Age 130    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Seth is born</li></ul> <p>Adam fathers a son "in his own likeness, after his image," and names him Seth. <i>Genesis 4:25; 5:3</i></p>                                                    |
| Age 930    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Dies</li></ul> <p>After 800 more years and more children, Adam dies, returning to the dust as God said. <i>Genesis 3:19; 5:4–5</i></p>                                                   |

# Key activities

*The Bible never says the forbidden fruit was an apple. That idea comes from later tradition and art.*

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- I Received the breath of life.** Adam did not make himself. God formed him from dust and gave him life. *Genesis 2:7*

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  - 2 Bore God's image.** He and the woman were made in God's image and told to fill the earth and rule over it. *Genesis 1:26-28*

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  - 3 Worked the garden.** God put him in Eden to tend and guard it. Work was part of life before sin entered. *Genesis 2:15*

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  - 4 Received one command.** He could eat from every tree but one. Disobedience would bring death. *Genesis 2:16-17*

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  - 5 Named the animals.** He named every living creature God brought to him, but found no helper fit for him. *Genesis 2:19-20*

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  - 6 Welcomed his wife.** He greeted the woman as "bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh." The text then gives the pattern for marriage. *Genesis 2:22-24*

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  - 7 Ate the forbidden fruit.** He was with his wife when she ate, and he took the fruit from her and ate. *Genesis 3:6*

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  - 8 Hid in fear.** He sewed fig leaves and hid among the trees. "I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself." *Genesis 3:7-10*

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  - 9 Shifted the blame.** He answered God, "The woman whom thou gavest to be with me, she gave me of the tree, and I did eat." *Genesis 3:11-12*

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  - 10 Named his wife Eve.** After hearing the sentence of death, he named her Eve, "because she was the mother of all living." *Genesis 3:20*

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  - 11 Left the garden.** He was sent out to till the ground from which he was taken. *Genesis 3:23-24*

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  - 12 Raised a family.** He fathered Cain, Abel, Seth, and other sons and daughters. Through Seth the line continues toward Noah. *Genesis 4:1-2, 25; 5:3-4*

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# Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Adam.

## Old Testament

|                      |                                                 |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Genesis 1:26–5:5     | The main account of his life                    |
| Genesis 3:15         | The woman's seed will bruise the serpent's head |
| Genesis 5:1–5        | "The book of the generations of Adam"           |
| 1 Chronicles 1:1     | Israel's genealogies start with Adam            |
| Job 31:33; Hosea 6:7 | Adam or "man"? Translators differ               |
| Echo: Psalm 8:4–6    | Humankind crowned to rule God's works           |

## New Testament

|                         |                                                   |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Luke 3:38               | Jesus' genealogy ends "the son of Adam"           |
| Romans 5:12–21          | Sin entered by one man; Adam a figure of Christ   |
| 1 Corinthians 15:22, 45 | "In Adam all die"; Christ "the last Adam"         |
| 1 Timothy 2:13–14       | Adam formed first; churches differ on application |
| Echo: Revelation 22:2–3 | The tree of life and "no more curse"              |

## For discussion

1. *Observe:* How did Adam answer when God asked, "Where art thou?" (Genesis 3:9–12)?
2. *Understand:* Adam blamed the woman and, in a way, God. Why is blame so natural?
3. *Apply:* God gave Adam work before the fall (Genesis 2:15). How does that shape how you see your work?
4. *Apply:* In Christ all are made alive (1 Corinthians 15:22). Where do you need that hope this week?